

Step 2: Knowledge-Base Document Creation

Fictional Organization: NovaCart Commerce

Domain: E-commerce / Online Retail

Purpose: Company knowledge base for customer complaint handling.

1. Complaint Policy

NovaCart accepts complaints about orders, products, payments, delivery, returns, refunds, cancellations, warranties, privacy, and customer service. Every complaint should include the order number where applicable, a clear description, relevant dates, and supporting evidence. Complaints must be handled professionally and confidentially. Unresolved complaints must be escalated according to the escalation procedure.

2. Refund Policy

Customers may request refunds for eligible products returned within the applicable return period and conditions. Refunds are normally issued after the returned item is received and inspected. Shipping charges may be refundable when the problem was caused by NovaCart, such as a damaged, incorrect, or defective item. Approved refunds should normally be sent to the original payment method.

3. Replacement Policy

A replacement may be offered when an item arrives damaged, defective, incomplete, or different from the item ordered. Photographs or other evidence may be requested. Replacement stock must be checked before dispatch. If the same item is unavailable, another eligible resolution such as a refund or store credit may be offered.

4. Cancellation Policy

Customers may request cancellation before an order enters the final dispatch process. If an order has already shipped, the customer may need to use the return procedure. Cancellation requests must be recorded against the order. If payment was already captured, the appropriate refund process must be followed.

5. Billing Policy

Billing complaints include duplicate charges, incorrect amounts, failed payments, and missing invoices. Customers should be charged the price and applicable taxes shown at checkout, subject to valid promotions and corrections. Payment details must be handled securely and never exposed in plain text. Unresolved billing disputes should be routed to Billing/Finance.

6. Delivery Policy

NovaCart provides an estimated delivery timeframe at checkout. Delays may occur because of carrier problems, weather, address issues, or operational conditions. Support should first provide the latest tracking information. Lost, severely delayed, or incorrectly delivered orders should be escalated to Logistics/Delivery.

7. Warranty Policy

Products covered by a manufacturer or NovaCart warranty receive support according to the applicable warranty terms. Warranty requests should include the order or purchase reference, product information, and fault description. Cases involving eligible warranty claims should be routed to Warranty/Technical Support.

8. Privacy Policy

NovaCart protects customer personal information and uses it only for legitimate business and support purposes. Staff must verify customers before discussing sensitive order information. Passwords, payment-card numbers, authentication codes, and other sensitive credentials must never be requested or exposed through ordinary support messages.

9. Escalation Procedure

Escalate cases that cannot be resolved by first-line support, involve a high-value or repeated issue, create a legal or privacy concern, or require specialist approval. Record the issue, actions already taken, evidence received, and requested resolution before escalation. Urgent privacy, security, or payment incidents should be escalated immediately.

10. Complaint SOP

Step 1: Receive and acknowledge the complaint. Step 2: Verify the customer and collect the order/reference number. Step 3: Identify the complaint category. Step 4: Check the relevant policy and order information. Step 5: Attempt an approved resolution. Step 6: Record the action and outcome. Step 7: Escalate when required. Step 8: Inform the customer about the next step and expected response time. Step 9: Close the complaint after the required resolution or final response.

11. Department-Routing Rules

Order status, delivery delay, lost shipment, and incorrect delivery → Logistics/Delivery. Refunds, duplicate charges, invoices, and payment disputes → Billing/Finance. Damaged or defective products → Returns/Warranty. Technical product problems → Technical Support. Privacy or personal-data concerns → Privacy/Security. General order, account, and policy questions → Customer Support. Multi-department cases should be assigned to the team responsible for the primary issue.

12. Service-Level Rules

Standard complaints should receive an initial response within 1 business day. Routine cases should normally be resolved or updated within 3 business days. Urgent payment, privacy, or security cases should be escalated immediately. If a case cannot be resolved on time, the customer should receive a status update and revised expected resolution time.

13. FAQs

Q: How can I request a refund? A: Contact Support with the order number and reason. Q: What if my item arrives damaged? A: Report it promptly and provide the order number and photographs if requested. Q: Can I cancel an order? A: Request cancellation before final dispatch. Q: My delivery is late. What should I do? A: Provide the order number so Support can check tracking. Q: How do I report a billing problem? A: Provide the order/reference number and explain the issue. Q: How is my information protected? A: Customer information is handled confidentially and shared only with authorized personnel when necessary.